missions from Thailand would continue until the Indian base was renovated in 1964, after which they undertook missions from Charbatia.[23]

In the aftermath of the war, there were two concerns in the administration—that India might make politically or militarily rash decisions or, on the flip side, give in to Chinese pressure due to lack of confidence.[24] The latter seemed less likely as Nehru showed little inclination to accept a Chinese settlement offer extended during the war.[25] As tempers cooled, the US worried even less about rash action—officials believed that Delhi would be careful not to provoke China in the near term.[26] And India indeed responded to proposals put forward by six nonaligned countries, in a move the US saw as designed to "put [the] ball neatly back in Peiping's court."[27]

That left a debate in the administration on the imminence of the Chinese threat. A National Security Council subcommittee concluded that there would not be another Chinese attack in spring 1963—and staffers did not think Indian policymakers expected one either.[28] Kennedy, however, wanted a fresh intelligence assessment of the possibility, and, as National Security Adviser McGeorge (Mac) Bundy put it, to know "if there is a prospect of the Chinese resuming the offensive, are we doing enough to help India? If we are doing enough, are we doing it soon enough?[29]

The State Department's assessment was that, while there might be minor skirmishes, there would not be another major Chinese attack that spring. Beijing would not want to "risk triggering US/UK intervention," especially when it did not gain anything more politically. China would also know that the US would benefit even more from another Chinese attack. Komer thought that the Indian government was "playing [the] threat up partly as a pitch for US aid, partly to keep Indian people alive to [the] threat." The US had already met Indian emergency requirements. With the change in the Indian defensive posture (i.e., more China focused), officials thought India was likely to be more militarily effective than before, and able to contain any Chinese advance into the Indian plains in the northeast. Thus, unlike Galbraith, the State Department saw little need to speed up the flow of aid to India, especially given limited Indian capacity to absorb the aid and the continued need to use the aid to keep India talking to Pakistan.[30] Secretary of Defense Robert McNamara, too, believed that for the next few years, the Chinese threat was "small." Director of Central Intelligence John McCone